

ADVIZEN

GUIDE FOR FINANCIAL SERVICES BUSINESSES

Tashkent International Financial Centre

The new common-law financial centre: law, tax, people and the road to activation

2026

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AT A GLANCE

A new legal order inside Tashkent

Decree UP-48 of 30 March 2026 created the Tashkent International Financial Centre (TIFC), and Constitutional Law ZRU-1158 of 13 July 2026 gave it its legal regime. The centre is expected to start operating in 2027.

TIFC is a defined territory with its own regulator, its own court and its own law. Inside it, the decisions of the centre's bodies prevail over conflicting national law, and English common law and equity fill the gaps.

The centre is open to banks, asset managers, insurers, market infrastructure, Islamic finance, digital-asset businesses, holding companies and the professional firms that serve them.

Qualified participants are exempt from profit tax and social tax on income from financial services until 1 January 2076. Foreign staff need no work permit, and national currency control does not apply to operations inside the centre.

This guide explains what the law already fixes, what is still to be written in the centre's resolutions, and how a business can prepare for activation.

ZRU-1158
Constitutional Law of 13 July 2026

2076
End of the profit tax and social tax exemptions

EUR 750m
Group revenue at which the exemption gives way to a 15% top-up tax

12 months
For the centre's bodies to adopt the founding resolutions

WHAT TIFC IS

Not another special economic zone

A special economic zone grants tax and customs relief inside the national legal system. TIFC replaces the legal system itself for the business done inside it.

	Special economic zone National legal system	TIFC Separate legal regime
Legal basis	Presidential decrees and the Law on Special Economic Zones	A constitutional law. Article 15 of the Constitution was amended to allow it
Governing law	Uzbek civil, corporate and commercial law	The centre's own acts, then English common law and equity where they are silent
Regulator	National ministries and the Central Bank	The Financial Services Authority of the centre
Disputes	Uzbek economic courts, in Uzbek or Russian	The Tashkent International Commercial Court, in English
Tax	Reliefs on top of the Tax Code, usually for a set number of years	The Tax Code applies only where the law or a TIFC resolution says so. Exemptions to 2076
Foreign staff	Work permits needed	No work permit for staff whose main workplace is the centre
Currency control	National rules apply	National rules do not apply to operations inside the centre

IN ONE LINE

An SEZ changes the price of doing business. TIFC changes the law that governs it: the contracts you sign, the court that hears your disputes and the regulator you answer to.

Which law applies inside the centre

Article 8 of the law sets the order of precedence. Where a higher source answers a question, the lower ones do not apply.

1
Constitution
The Constitution of the Republic of Uzbekistan

2
ZRU-1158
The Constitutional Law on the centre

3
Presidential acts
Decrees and resolutions of the President on the centre

4
TIFC resolutions
Acts of the centre's bodies, called TIFC decisions

5
English law
Principles of common law and equity of England and Wales where nothing else applies

Primacy inside the territory

Within the centre, TIFC decisions prevail over any conflicting national law. The TIFC Council decides which English legislation applies, as of which date and with what changes. Common law and equity then fill the remaining gaps.

National law that still applies

- The Constitution and criminal law
- A limited part of administrative liability
- National security, defence and anti-money-laundering rules
- Immigration, family, environmental, public health and emergency law
- International treaties and any national law a TIFC resolution adopts

Article 12 of Constitutional Law ZRU-1158. Everything outside these areas is governed by the TIFC framework.



COMMON LAW

What changes for your contracts

Uzbekistan is a civil-law country with codified private law. Inside TIFC, two participants can sign under TIFC law and litigate in an English-language court on terms familiar from London, Dubai or Astana.

01 **Precedent**

Outcomes follow a long line of decided cases on standard commercial terms, so lenders and funds can price legal risk.

02 **Freedom of contract**

Courts enforce the bargain as written. Civil codes more often impose mandatory rules over what the parties agreed.

03 **Trusts and equity**

Trusts, specific performance and injunctions have no direct equivalent in Uzbek civil law. Funds and security structures rely on them.

04 **Interpretation**

Contracts are read by their words and commercial purpose, which is how international finance and M&A documents are drafted.

05 **Remedies**

Equitable relief, freezing orders and settled measures of damages come from the common-law tradition.

06 **One forum**

Parties no longer need to choose a foreign law and a foreign court and then enforce the result in Uzbekistan.

WHO CAN OPERATE

Activities open in the centre

Article 7 covers almost the whole range of financial services and the functions around them.

Banking and markets

- ☐ Deposits, lending and project finance
- ☐ Trading in financial instruments, currencies, commodities and derivatives
- ☐ Brokerage, market making and payment services

Asset management and Islamic finance

- ☐ Fund, portfolio, pension and hedge fund management
- ☐ Securities issuance and trading, crowdfunding, financial advice
- ☐ Sharia-compliant banking, investment and capital markets

Insurance and infrastructure

- ☐ Insurance and reinsurance, underwriting and brokerage
- ☐ Custody, clearing, settlement and depositories
- ☐ Stock and commodity exchanges, alternative trading systems

Digital assets and support

- ☐ Issuance, trading and custody of digital assets, digital-asset exchanges and funds
- ☐ Audit, accounting, legal and rating services
- ☐ Holding companies, special purpose vehicles, treasury companies and representative offices

STILL TO BE DEFINED

Which of these count as qualifying financial services for the tax exemption, and the licensing rules for each, will be set by TIFC resolutions and the Financial Services Authority.

The 2076 exemption and its limits

The Tax Code applies inside the centre only where the Constitutional Law or a TIFC resolution expressly says so (Article 18).

	Standard Uzbek LLC	Qualified TIFC participant
Profit tax	15%	0% on income from financial services until 1 January 2076
Social tax	12% of payroll	0% until 2076 on qualifying activity
Dividends, VAT and personal income tax	10% withholding on dividends to non-residents, 5% to residents, 12% VAT, 12% personal income tax	Set by TIFC resolutions, not yet adopted
Conditions	None beyond the Tax Code	Economic substance, governance and anti-money-laundering compliance
Groups with revenue of EUR 750m or more	Standard rates and the Pillar Two rules	No exemption. A qualified domestic minimum top-up tax at the standard 15% rate

TIFC bodies

The centre's bodies and the entities they wholly own are exempt from profit tax and social tax until 1 January 2076.

The Pillar Two test

A participant loses the exemption if its group had consolidated revenue of EUR 750 million or more in at least two of the four preceding years (Article 19).

IN PRACTICE

For a mid-sized financial services business the regime is a fifty-year holiday. For a large international group it is closer to the standard Uzbek rate, with the legal and operational advantages of the centre.



OPERATING IN THE CENTRE

People, money and assets

Foreign staff and visas

- **No work permit and no quota** for qualified foreign staff whose main workplace is the centre (Article 21)
- The TIFC Administration sets the qualification requirements and keeps the register of foreign staff
- **Entry visa** at an Uzbek embassy or on arrival at an international airport (Article 20)
- Visas of up to five years for persons who qualify as TIFC persons

Currency and assets

- Obligations between participants can be set and settled in **foreign currency**, and in digital assets within the limits of the centre's rules (Article 17)
- No registration of currency contracts, no notices on capital movements and no limits on foreign accounts, unless a TIFC resolution agreed with the Central Bank says otherwise
- **No confiscation, nationalisation or freezing** of participants' assets except by order of the centre's court or under AML, sanctions, criminal or insolvency law (Article 6)

COMMERCIAL DISPUTES STAY COMMERCIAL

Conduct that is in substance a civil or commercial dispute is handled first through the civil and regulatory tools of the centre, not referred to national authorities for criminal prosecution (Article 14).

INSTITUTIONS

Who runs the centre

Article 22 creates four bodies, each financially and operationally independent. A Governor appointed by Presidential decree coordinates them and the link with the state.

01 **TIFC Council**

At least five members. Sets strategy, approves budgets and adopts TIFC resolutions.

02 **TIFC Administration**

The executive body that registers participants, runs the centre and promotes it.

03 **Financial Services Authority**

The independent regulator. Licenses, supervises and enforces in financial and ancillary services.

04 **International Commercial Court**

Hears disputes in English (Article 30). It also serves the IT Park.

Investment tax residency

Article 13 creates the status of TIFC investment tax resident for individuals who make qualifying investments in Uzbekistan, and for their family members. The TIFC Council will set the forms, amounts and instruments of investment.

- Not a tax resident of Uzbekistan in the three years before applying
- Uzbek citizenship not terminated in the ten years before applying
- Status may be refused where a main purpose of the application is improper

Each body publishes an annual transparency report within four months of the end of the financial year. Investment thresholds for the residency programme are not yet published.

COMPARISON

TIFC and the established centres

TIFC follows the common-law model of the Gulf centres and, most closely, the Astana International Financial Centre. It adds a Pillar Two carve-out and a digital-asset mandate from the start.

	TIFC Tashkent, 2026	AIFC Astana, 2018	DIFC Dubai, 2004	ADGM Abu Dhabi, 2015	QFC Doha, 2005
Legal basis	Constitutional law	Constitutional statute	Federal and emirate law	Federal and emirate law	State law
Applicable law	Own acts, then English common law and equity	Own acts based on English common law	Own civil and commercial laws on common-law principles	English common law applied directly	Own common-law based civil and commercial rules
Regulator	Financial Services Authority	AFSA	DFSA	FSRA	QFC Regulatory Authority
Court	Tashkent International Commercial Court	AIFC Court and arbitration centre	DIFC Courts	ADGM Courts	QFC court and tribunal
Tax on profits	0% to 2076 on financial services, Pillar Two carve-out	Exemption to 2066	Free zone tax concessions	Free zone tax concessions	10% on locally sourced profits

WHAT THIS MEANS

TIFC is neither an outlier nor a copy. It takes a template investors already know, and its practical value will depend on the resolutions, the regulator and the court in their first years of work.

Peer centres in summary form, for orientation only. Each has its own detailed rules and exceptions.

TIMELINE

The road to activation

The centre opens once its founding resolutions are adopted and the President approves activation.

March 2026	**Centre created** Decree UP-48 of 30 March 2026 creates the centre and the Tashkent International Commercial Court
July 2026	**Law signed and in force** ZRU-1158 of 13 July, in force since 25 July. Article 15 of the Constitution amended
September 2026	**Governor appointed** By Presidential decree of 10 September 2026
Within 12 months	**Founding resolutions** Governance, regulation, the court and daily operation. Extendable by up to six months (Article 31)
Expected 2027	**Activation** The Council submits the activation decision to the President. Officials expect the centre to start in 2027
After activation	**Transitional routes** Uzbek licensees register a subsidiary or branch within 60 days (Article 32). Foreign licensees get a transitional licence where a cooperation agreement exists (Article 33)

OPEN QUESTIONS TO WATCH

- Qualifying financial services and substance conditions
- Dividend, VAT and personal income tax inside the centre
- Thresholds for investment tax residency
- Which English legislation applies, from which date
- Foreign regulators eligible for transitional licences

HOW WE HELP

Preparing for the centre

We follow the TIFC resolutions as they are adopted and turn them into a concrete entry decision for your business.

01 **Structure review**

Whether TIFC or a standard Uzbek structure fits your model better.

02 **Tax modelling**

The outcome under the exemption, including the Pillar Two position of larger groups.

03 **Transitional routes**

Options for existing Uzbek and foreign licensees and the 60-day window.

04 **Company and licensing**

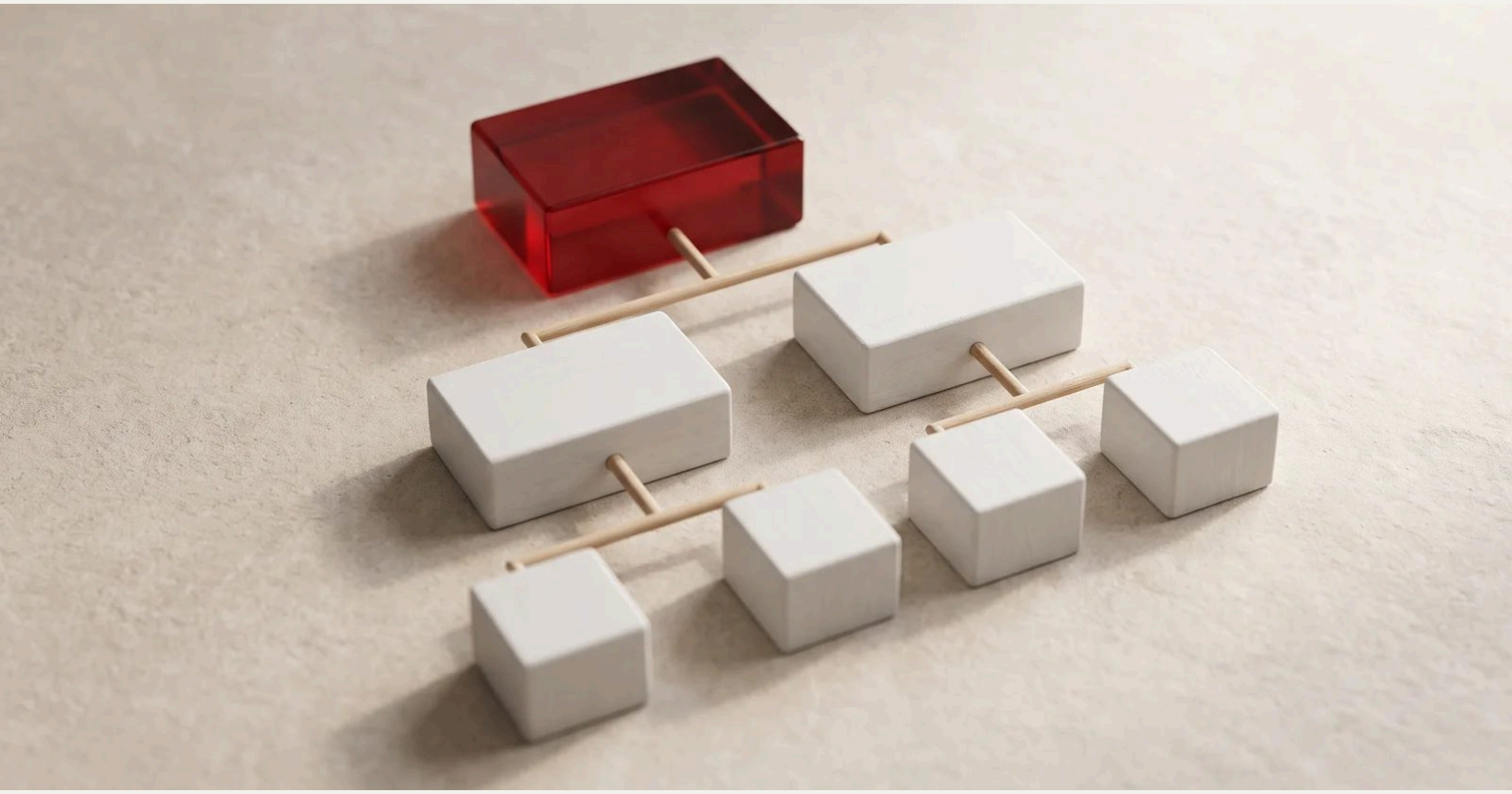
Registration, licence applications and substance on the ground.

05 **People**

Hiring, visas and registration for foreign staff and their families.

06 **Accounting and reporting**

Bookkeeping, financial statements and reporting to the centre's bodies.





CONTACTS

Considering the Tashkent International Financial Centre?

Tell us about your business and your plans. We answer in English, Russian, Uzbek or German. The first call is free.

Book an introductory call

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